



Staff Makeup Scheduling SOP

Virginia University of Integrative Medicine Effective: Spring 2026

1. Purpose and Scope

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the administrative role of clinic reception and staff in the student makeup process. Its purpose is to ensure that makeup scheduling occurs only for approved students and to maintain clinic flow through proper verification and communication.

2. Staff Role in the Makeup Workflow

Reception and administrative staff support the clinical makeup process by:

- Verifying makeup approval via the Live Clinic Schedule (LCS).
- Supporting operational scheduling only after makeup approval is verified on the LCS.
- Coordinating with Supervisors regarding patient arrival and operational needs.

Staff do not approve makeup requests, adjudicate attendance rules, or determine treatment credit eligibility.

Virginia University of Integrative Medicine

Main: 1980 Gallows Rd, Vienna, VA 22182 | School: 703-323-5690 | Clinic: 703-323-5691 | Fax: 703-323-5692
725 Grand Ave. Suite 303-304, Ridgely, MD 21077 | School: 703-323-5690 | Clinic: 703-323-5691
3525 Mall Blvd NW, 5A, B Duluth, GA 30096 | School: 703-323-5690 | Clinic: 703-323-5691

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3. Using the LCS as the Staff-Facing Operational Source

The **Live Clinic Schedule (LCS)**, located in the Populi Links section, is the authoritative operational source of truth for staff.

- **The Blue Makeup Section:** Staff must check the designated blue section of the LCS for the specific date and shift.
 - **Verification:** If a student's name and the specific makeup date are listed in this section, staff have the necessary operational context to schedule patients or update the roster as directed.
 - **Absence of Entry:** If a student is not listed in the blue makeup section for that specific date, they are not considered approved for operational scheduling.
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4. Operational Scheduling After LCS Verification

Staff may support roster updates or patient scheduling only after the student's approved makeup placement is verified on the LCS and under supervisor direction.

5. What Staff Should Not Treat as Proof of Approval

To maintain policy integrity, staff must never operationalize a makeup based on:

- **Verbal Claims:** A student stating they were told they could attend.
 - **Email Chains or Informal Messages:** Messages that do not change the authoritative operational record.
 - **Supervisor Permission:** While supervisors manage the floor, they do not grant the underlying administrative approval for a makeup.
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6. When Staff Should Defer to the Supervisor

Staff must defer to the on-site Supervisor for all real-time clinic flow and instructional decisions, including:

- **Group Placement:** Determining which specific group the makeup intern will join for the shift.
 - **Group Feasibility:** Assessing whether a specific group has the capacity to take on an additional intern or a specific patient.
 - **Intern Roles:** Any questions regarding whether a student is acting as a lead or assistant intern.
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7. When Staff Should Refer Issues to the DCE

Staff should refer unresolved approval or workflow issues to the DCE Office (dce@vuim.edu), including when:

- The student believes they are approved, but their name is missing from the LCS.
 - There is an operational discrepancy that cannot be resolved through the LCS and normal supervisor coordination.
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8. What Staff Are Not Responsible For

Staff roles are strictly administrative. Staff are not responsible for:

- **Documentation Adjudication:** Reviewing or signing Clinical Diaries or other workbook materials.
- **Credit Enforcement:** Determining if an intern earned treatment or observation credit.
- **Attendance Decisions:** Deciding if an absence should be excused or unexcused.

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9. Related Scheduling Escalation Note: Late Patients

In the interest of clinic flow and EAM educational standards, staff must follow this rule for patient punctuality:

- **15-Minute Rule:** If a patient arrives 15 or more minutes late for their appointment, staff must not independently assure the patient they will be seen.
- **Supervisor Confirmation:** Staff must confirm with the Supervisor whether the group can still accommodate the patient.
- **Final Authority:** The Supervisor makes the final decision based on the remaining shift time and intern workload.

10. Key Takeaways

- **LCS Verification:** If the student is not listed in the blue section of the LCS for that date, staff should not operationalize the makeup.
- **Operational Scheduling Follows LCS:** Do not operationalize or schedule a makeup placement before checking the LCS.
- **No Verbal Approvals:** Always require formal operational confirmation.
- **Consult Supervisors:** Defer to supervisors for all late-patient and group-placement decisions.
- **Narrow Staff Role:** Staff verify, coordinate, and escalate. They do not approve, adjudicate, or determine credit.

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11. Disclaimer

This SOP serves as an operational guide for staff. Formal authority on all attendance and makeup matters rests with the VUIM Student and Supervisor Handbooks. In the event of a conflict between this guide and the Handbooks (as updated by official University memos), the Handbooks shall govern.

Questions? Contact the DCE Office: dce@vuim.edu

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